Reflective Essay 3.1: Relevance of Non-Digital Instructional Materials in 21st Century Teaching

Before studying this lesson, I already had an idea about the importance of instructional materials in teaching because I experienced using different materials during my elementary and high school years. At that time, we mostly used traditional materials such as blackboards, manila paper, cartolina, and pictures during classroom discussions. Since technology was not yet as common and accessible as it is today, teachers depended more on these materials to deliver their lessons. After studying this topic, I realized that non-digital instructional materials are still important even in the 21st century. Technology may have changed the way teachers teach, but it does not mean that traditional materials have lost their purpose in the learning process.

When I recall my experiences as a highschool student, I remember how our teachers used blackboards to write important information and we copied all of it in our notebooks. Sometimes, these simple daily routines helped us understand the lesson because we could easily see the information being presented. For me, these materials were effective because they made classroom discussions more organized and allowed students to participate. However, I can say that traditional materials have limitations, especially when teachers need to present complicated concepts that require videos, animations, or other interactive resources. For me, the effectiveness of an instructional material does not depend on whether it is digital or non-digital but on how the teacher uses it. This lesson made me realize that as a future educator, I should not depend entirely on technology. Instead, I should learn how to combine traditional and modern instructional materials depending on the needs of my students.

After reading this module, I learned that non-digital instructional materials remain relevant because they are accessible, practical, and useful in creating meaningful learning experiences. As a future English teacher, I want to use different instructional materials to make my lessons more interesting and understandable. I also want to be resourceful because not every classroom has complete technological equipment. I realized that being an effective teacher is not about having the most expensive or modern tools but knowing how to use available resources to help students learn.

Reflective Essay 3.3: My Digital Literacy Skills

As a student in this generation, technology has become part of my everyday academic life. I use different applications and digital tools when completing school requirements, preparing presentations, and gathering information. However, studying this lesson about digital literacy made me realize that knowing how to use technology does not automatically mean

that I am already skilled in using it. There are still things that I find difficult, especially when it comes to creating digital outputs such as PowerPoint presentations and edited videos.

Based on my personal experience, I sometimes struggle when our teachers assign projects that require video editing or creating an organized PowerPoint presentation. These activities sometimes require knowledge of editing applications, their features, and the proper techniques for producing a good output. Since I am not very familiar with some of these applications, I sometimes find myself having difficulty completing the tasks. There are times when I know what I want my presentation or video to look like, but I do not know exactly how to achieve it using the available tools. This makes me realize that my weakness is not necessarily my willingness to use technology but my limited knowledge of some digital production skills. On the other hand, I can use applications such as Canva, WPS, Google Docs, and Picsart. I also have some knowledge of using computers, keyboard shortcuts, and other digital devices. After reading this lesson, I understood that digital literacy involves more than simply operating applications. It also includes knowing how to find, evaluate, use, create, and communicate information properly. I also realized that I need to improve my ability to create digital content because these skills will become important once I start teaching.

This lesson helped me recognize both my strengths and weaknesses in digital literacy. I may already have basic knowledge of different digital tools, but I still have many things to learn, particularly in creating multimedia outputs. As a future educator, I want to become more confident in using technology because I know that digital tools can make lessons more engaging and accessible. I believe that learning these skills takes time and practice, and I am willing to improve little by little.

Reflective Essay 4.1: My Understanding of Dale's Cone of Experience

Before learning about Edgar Dale's Cone of Experience, I already believed that students learn better when they are given opportunities to participate in activities rather than simply listening to discussions. Personally, I am the type of student who easily gets bored during long discussions, especially when the teacher does not make the lesson interesting. I become more active when there are demonstrations, experiments, and activities where I can apply what I have learned. After reading this lesson, I understood why actual experiences and active participation are important in the teaching and learning process.

One experience that I can relate to Dale's Cone of Experience happened during my high school years when our science teacher conducted an experiment about volcanoes. Instead of only discussing how volcanoes work, our teacher allowed us to participate in an actual experiment. I found the activity more interesting because I could observe what was happening instead of simply imagining the process based on the teacher's explanation. It

also helped me connect the information from our previous lessons to something that I could actually see. Looking back, I realized that this experience helped me understand the lesson more effectively because I was actively involved in the learning process. Dale's Cone of Experience explains different levels of learning experiences, from direct purposeful experiences to more abstract forms such as visual and verbal symbols. This made me understand that teachers should provide different learning experiences depending on the lesson and the needs of their students. As a future English teacher, I can apply this by allowing my students to participate in role-playing, storytelling, demonstrations, and other classroom activities. For example, instead of only discussing a literary character, I can ask students to perform a short scene to help them understand the character's emotions and actions. I believe that students should not only hear and read information but also experience and apply what they have learned.

This lesson taught me that learning becomes more meaningful when students are actively involved in the process. My experience with the volcano experiment showed me how an activity can make a lesson more interesting and easier to understand. In the future, I want to create classroom experiences where students can participate rather than remain passive listeners. I realized that a good teacher should not only explain information but also provide opportunities for students to experience learning in different ways.

Reflective Essay 4.2 (A): Evaluating My Personal Capabilities Through the TPACK Framework

Before studying the TPACK framework, I used to think that being a teacher mainly required having enough knowledge about the subject and knowing how to explain it to students. However, this lesson helped me understand that effective teaching requires the combination of three important areas: Content Knowledge, Pedagogical Knowledge, and Technological Knowledge. As a pre-service English teacher, I tried to evaluate myself based on these three areas. Through this reflection, I realized that I already have some capabilities, but I still have several things to improve before I become a professional teacher.

When it comes to Content Knowledge, I can honestly say that my knowledge of the English language is not yet that extensive. There are still many grammar rules, vocabulary words, and language concepts that I need to understand. However, I consider myself a learner who is still in the process of developing and improving my knowledge. For Pedagogical Knowledge, I believe that my ability to explain lessons has improved compared to when I was in high school. I am now more comfortable explaining something in front of my classmates, but I still need to study and understand the material first before presenting it. I know that I cannot explain everything, especially when the topic is unfamiliar to me. Lastly, when it comes to Technological Knowledge, I consider my ability quite good because I can operate computers, use keyboard shortcuts, and work with applications such as Canva,

WPS, Google Docs, and Picsart. I also have some background knowledge in using digital devices such as smart TVs. However, I still find some applications, particularly Excel and certain editing tools, difficult to use. Evaluating myself through TPACK made me realize that having one strong area is not enough. A teacher needs to combine knowledge of the subject, teaching strategies, and appropriate technology. For example, knowing how to use PowerPoint is useful, but I should also know how to organize its content and present it in a way that helps students understand the lesson.

Overall, I realized that my TPACK is still developing, and I should not expect myself to become fully capable in all three areas immediately. I need to continue improving my English knowledge, developing my teaching strategies, and exploring different technological applications. As a future educator, I want to achieve a balance between these three areas because I believe that effective teaching is not simply about knowing the lesson but also knowing how to deliver it using appropriate methods and resources.

Reflective Essay 4.2 (B): The Importance of Theoretical Frameworks in Becoming an Effective Teacher

Before studying this lesson, I used to believe that teaching was mostly about knowing the subject, preparing a discussion, and explaining the lesson to students. I did not fully understand that there are different theoretical frameworks that guide teachers in planning and delivering instruction. Through this lesson, I became familiar with TPACK, SAMR, and Bloom's Revised Taxonomy. These frameworks helped me realize that teaching requires proper planning, decision-making, and understanding of how students learn.

As I studied these frameworks, I realized that each of them provides a different guide for improving the teaching and learning process. TPACK explains the importance of combining content knowledge, pedagogical knowledge, and technological knowledge. SAMR helps teachers understand different levels of technology integration, starting from simple substitution to the redefinition of learning activities. Meanwhile, Bloom's Revised Taxonomy provides a guide for developing students' thinking skills, from remembering and understanding to applying, analyzing, evaluating, and creating. Before learning these concepts, I did not pay much attention to how teachers selected their instructional strategies and technological tools. I usually focused only on the lesson itself. However, I now understand that teachers should have a clear reason for choosing a particular method or activity. For example, using PowerPoint in a classroom is not automatically an effective use of technology. The teacher should consider whether it actually improves the students' learning experience. I can relate this to my experience as a student because I have attended classes where teachers mostly discussed the lesson while students simply listened. Although discussions are important, I believe that students also need activities that allow them to think, participate, and create something based on what they have learned.

These frameworks made me realize that becoming an effective teacher requires more than personal knowledge and confidence. It also requires understanding the principles that guide good instruction.

This lesson changed the way I look at teaching. I learned that theoretical frameworks are important because they provide direction and help teachers make better decisions when planning lessons. As a future English teacher, I want to apply these frameworks when preparing my instructional materials and classroom activities. I know that I still have much to learn, but understanding these concepts gives me a better idea of what kind of teacher I want to become: someone who does not simply deliver information but creates meaningful learning experiences for students.

Reflective Essay 4.3: My Learning Experience with the ASSURE Model

Creating a lesson plan is one of the responsibilities that I am beginning to experience as a pre-service teacher. In our Technology for Teaching and Learning subject, I already had the opportunity to create my own lesson plan as part of our academic requirements. At first, I thought that preparing a lesson plan was mainly about choosing a topic, writing objectives, and listing classroom activities. However, studying the ASSURE Model helped me understand that effective lesson planning involves several important considerations, especially the characteristics of learners and the proper selection of instructional materials and activities.

The ASSURE Model introduced me to six important steps: Analyze Learner Characteristics, State Objectives, Select, Modify or Design Materials, Utilize Materials, Require Learner Response, and Evaluate. Among these steps, I find engaging students and requiring their active participation particularly challenging. Based on my experience during classroom presentations in college, not all students are interested in the lesson being discussed. Some are easily distracted by their own activities, while others seem to be waiting only for the class to finish. This makes me realize that delivering a lesson is not always easy because having a well-prepared discussion does not guarantee that students will participate. I sometimes find it challenging to think of ways to catch their attention and encourage them to become involved. Through the ASSURE Model, I realized that teachers should consider the learners' characteristics before deciding how to deliver a lesson. They should also prepare appropriate objectives, materials, and activities that will encourage participation. For example, instead of relying entirely on classroom discussions, I can include short games, group activities, or interactive exercises related to the lesson. I also learned that evaluating the effectiveness of a lesson is important because teachers need to determine whether students actually achieved the intended learning objectives. If I find it difficult to engage my future students, I should explore different teaching strategies, observe their responses, and ask for feedback so I can improve my approach.

Overall, the ASSURE Model taught me that effective lesson planning requires careful preparation and consideration of the learners. My experience in preparing lesson plans and conducting classroom presentations helped me understand that one of the biggest challenges in teaching is keeping students interested and actively involved. In the future, I will use the ASSURE Model as a guide when preparing my lessons. I know that I still need to improve my classroom management and teaching strategies, but I believe that through practice and experience, I can become more effective in handling different learners.

Reflective Essay 5.1: Understanding Assessment and Setting Clear Expectations

As a student, I have experienced different types of classroom assessments, such as written examinations, oral presentations, group activities, and performance tasks. One thing I noticed from most of my teachers is that they usually explain the rubrics and criteria before we begin an activity. Through this lesson, I realized how important it is for students to understand what is expected of them before performing a particular task. I also learned that technology plays an important role in assessment because it provides teachers with additional ways to monitor and evaluate student learning.

Based on my experience, most of my teachers explain the rubrics before giving us an activity and allow us to ask questions if something is unclear. Because of this, we understand what we should and should not do, as well as the specific criteria that will be used to evaluate our performance. I believe this practice helps us perform better because we have a clear direction and know what we need to accomplish. Without clear instructions and expectations, students might become confused about the requirements and fail to meet the intended objectives. This experience helped me understand the importance of communication between teachers and students. I also learned that assessment is not only about giving grades but also about gathering information about students' learning and identifying areas that need improvement. In this modern generation, ICT can help teachers conduct assessments, record students' scores, and provide immediate feedback. For example, teachers can use online examination platforms or digital applications to prepare quizzes and monitor student performance. These tools can make the assessment process faster and more organized. As a future teacher, I want to follow the practices that I appreciated from my previous teachers. I will make sure that my students understand the instructions and grading criteria before they begin an activity. I also want to use appropriate digital tools to make assessment more efficient and provide timely feedback.

This lesson helped me understand that clear expectations and proper assessment are important parts of effective teaching. My experiences as a student showed me that explaining the rubrics and allowing students to ask questions can help them perform better. As a future English teacher, I want to make my assessment process fair, understandable,

and meaningful. I also want to remember that assessment should not only measure what students know but should also help them recognize their progress and improve their learning.

Reflective Essay 5.2: The Role of ICT and Conventional Methods in Assessment

As a student, I have experienced different assessment methods, including written examinations, oral recitations, reporting, performance tasks, and group activities. Among these, I personally enjoy reporting and it's my favorite because it allows me to share what I have understood about a particular topic with my classmates. After studying this lesson, I realized that assessment is not limited to written examinations and that teachers can use different methods to evaluate students' knowledge, skills, and abilities. I also learned that both ICT-based and conventional assessment methods have their own advantages and limitations.

When I was in highschool, I found reporting more enjoyable than written activities because unlike written activities, in reporting I have the opportunity to explain a topic using my own understanding and also allows me to organize my thoughts and communicate information to other people. For me, reporting is a good way to assess students because it not only measures their knowledge but also develops their communication and presentation skills. After reading this lesson, I learned that ICT can provide additional ways to assess student learning. For example, teachers can use Google Forms, online quizzes, and computer-based examinations to collect responses, record scores, and provide immediate feedback. These tools can save time and make the assessment process more organized. But on the down side, relying entirely on technology has limitations. Some students may have difficulty accessing digital devices or the internet because of their location or because they can't afford having digital device, and also, technical problems can affect their performance. On the other hand, Conventional assessment methods are often more accessible because they do not always require an internet connection or electronic devices. However, checking written examinations manually can take more time, and some traditional tests may not fully measure students' practical skills and creativity. As a future educator, I want to use a combination of different assessment methods depending on the learning objectives. I can use written examinations to measure students' understanding, reporting to develop their communication skills, and performance tasks to assess their ability to apply what they have learned. When selecting assessment tools, I should consider the objectives, the needs and abilities of the learners, the accuracy of the results, and the time and resources required.

In summary, this lesson taught me that assessment should be flexible and should provide students with different opportunities to demonstrate their learning. My personal experience with reporting helped me realize that students can show their understanding in ways other

than written examinations. As a future English teacher, I want to create a balanced assessment system that combines traditional and technology-based methods. Most importantly, I want my students to see assessment not only as a requirement for grades but also as an opportunity to demonstrate their abilities and improve themselves.